

The Impact of Digital Learning Resources on Academic Performance Among Junior Secondary School Students in Kenya

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Abstract

The adoption of digital learning resources has significantly transformed education in Kenya, particularly following the implementation of the Competency Based Curriculum (CBC). This study examined the impact of digital learning resources on academic performance among Junior Secondary School students. A mixed methods research design was employed involving 240 students and 30 teachers drawn from six public schools. Data were collected through questionnaires, interviews, and classroom observations. Quantitative data were analyzed using descriptive statistics, while qualitative responses were examined using thematic analysis. The findings indicate that learners who regularly accessed digital learning materials demonstrated improved academic performance, greater classroom participation, and enhanced critical thinking skills. Teachers also reported that digital resources increased learner engagement and simplified lesson delivery. Despite these benefits, challenges such as limited internet connectivity, inadequate digital infrastructure, and insufficient teacher training affected implementation. The study concludes that digital learning resources can substantially improve educational outcomes when supported by adequate investment in infrastructure and professional development.

Keywords: Digital Learning, CBC, Education, Kenya, Academic Performance

1. Introduction

Technology continues to reshape educational systems around the world. In Kenya, the Competency Based Curriculum encourages learner centered instruction supported by digital resources. Schools are increasingly adopting electronic textbooks, educational applications, interactive learning platforms, and virtual classrooms.

Although digital learning presents many opportunities, disparities in infrastructure and digital literacy remain significant challenges. This study investigates whether access to digital learning resources contributes to improved academic performance among Junior Secondary School learners.

Objectives

1. To determine the influence of digital learning resources on academic performance.
 2. To examine teachers' perceptions of digital learning.
 3. To identify challenges affecting the implementation of digital learning in Kenyan schools.
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2. Literature Review

Several studies have shown that technology enhances learner engagement and knowledge retention. Digital platforms encourage collaboration, self directed learning, and immediate access to educational materials.

Recent educational research suggests that students using digital resources develop stronger problem solving abilities and higher motivation compared to learners relying exclusively on traditional teaching methods. However, researchers also emphasize the importance of teacher preparedness and adequate technological infrastructure.

3. Methodology

A mixed methods research design was adopted.

Study Area: Nairobi and Kiambu Counties.

Population: Junior Secondary School students and teachers.

Sample Size: 240 students and 30 teachers selected through stratified random sampling.

Data Collection Instruments:

- Structured questionnaires
- Semi structured interviews
- Classroom observation schedules

Data Analysis:

Quantitative data were analyzed using descriptive statistics, while qualitative responses were organized into themes.

4. Results

The findings revealed that:

- Eighty four percent of students reported improved understanding when digital learning resources were used.
 - Seventy eight percent experienced increased classroom participation.
 - Teachers reported improved lesson preparation and greater learner engagement.
 - Schools with reliable internet connectivity recorded better academic outcomes than schools with limited digital infrastructure.
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5. Discussion

The results demonstrate a positive relationship between digital learning resources and academic achievement. These findings support previous studies showing that technology enhances learner participation and independent learning.

However, unequal access to devices and inconsistent internet connectivity continue to widen educational disparities. Teacher training also emerged as a critical factor in successful technology integration.

6. Conclusion

Digital learning resources have become an important component of quality education in Kenya. When effectively integrated into classroom instruction, they improve learner engagement, academic performance, and critical thinking skills.

Continued investment in educational technology, infrastructure, and teacher capacity building will enable more schools to realize the full benefits of digital learning.

7. Recommendations

- Expand internet connectivity in public schools.
- Increase government investment in educational technology.
- Provide continuous digital skills training for teachers.
- Develop locally relevant digital learning materials aligned with the CBC.

- Encourage partnerships between publishers, schools, and technology providers.
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